

Integrated Pest Management (IPM) Plan — DRAFT

Combinable Crops & Sugar Beet · Prepared 24 September 2026

DRAFT pending confirmation. Note: the farm's SFI1 agreement (ref UAF332270030/1690256) already includes an 'IPM1 — integrated pest management plan review' action. If Savills or the agronomist already produced a plan for that action, use that document instead of this draft — it will already meet this Red Tractor requirement. This draft exists as a fallback if no such document can be located.

1. Approach

Upper Assendon Farm follows an integrated approach to pest, weed and disease management, using cultural and monitoring-based methods to reduce reliance on plant protection products (PPPs), applying PPPs only where thresholds justify it.

2. Cultural controls

- Crop rotation across the combinable cropping area to break pest and disease cycles.
- Variety choice: [CONFIRM] whether disease-resistant or tolerant varieties are selected where available.
- Cultivation timing adjusted to manage grass-weed pressure (e.g. blackgrass) where relevant.
- Field margins (SFI/CS options — buffer strips, nectar mixes, winter bird food) maintained across the farm, supporting natural predators of crop pests.

3. Monitoring

- Crops walked regularly through the season by James and/or the BASIS-qualified agronomist to assess pest, weed and disease pressure before any treatment decision.
- Treatment thresholds followed per agronomist recommendation rather than routine/calendar spraying.
- Weather and forecast conditions checked before spray applications (recorded in spray records).

4. Chemical controls — used as a last resort

- PPPs selected and applied only on agronomist recommendation, appropriate to the target and label conditions.
- Products rotated by mode of action where resistance risk applies (e.g. herbicide/fungicide resistance management).
- All applications recorded (see Spray Records) — 610+ entries currently on file.
- Local beekeeper (Oxfordshire Beekeepers Association, obka.org.uk, 07707 147312) to be notified ahead of any spraying on flowering crops.

5. Review

This plan is reviewed annually alongside the Nutrient Management Plan and before each new cropping season. Last reviewed: 24 September 2026 — to be updated once agronomist input on [CONFIRM] items above is received.